

ANGEL ACTION · MEDICAL

Fainting (Syncope)

Fainting is a brief loss of consciousness from reduced blood flow to the brain. Lay the person flat, raise their legs above heart level, and look for an underlying cause if recovery is slow.

Signs

- Sudden brief loss of consciousness
- Pale, sweaty, cold skin
- Slow pulse
- Quick recovery (usually within a minute or two)

What to do

1. Follow **DRSABCD**.
2. Lay the person **flat** and **raise their legs above heart level** (about 30 cm) to restore blood flow to the brain.
3. Loosen tight clothing and ensure fresh air.
4. Check for and treat any injuries from the fall.
5. As they recover, reassure them and let them sit up slowly.
6. If not recovered within **2 minutes**, call **000**.
7. If unconscious but breathing, place in the **recovery position**.

When fainting is a warning sign

Seek medical advice if fainting happens during exertion, with chest pain or palpitations, repeatedly, or in someone over 50 — it can be a sign of a heart problem or **stroke**.

*Adapted from **Australian First Aid 5th Edition**. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at firstaidangel.org.*